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CYLINDER USER GUIDE

OverHead Cylinder User Guide

A practical guide for Cylinder Server administrators and workstation users.

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Practical instructions for setup, daily work, data handling, updates, and recovery.

Read this first
Product behavior and available controls vary by edition, Windows compatibility, account role, plan, and connected services. This guide explains current product workflows; it is not legal, accounting, or security advice.

Use the table of contents to find a task. Read the data and security boundaries before moving, exporting, restoring, or sharing records.

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1. Understand Server and Client roles

Cylinder is the department-managed OverHead capacity. It has two separate Windows packages: Cylinder Server, the department host, and Cylinder Client, the managed employee endpoint. Both share the core workspaces and local data behavior, but only the Server host exposes the department's central management controls.

Package	Supported host	Purpose
Cylinder Server	Windows Server or Windows IoT; Manager verifies the supported build and hardware rules.	Department workspace and Rank/device policy control plane.
Cylinder Client	Windows 10/11 managed workstation or remote desktop endpoint.	Employee access to an approved Cylinder workspace; no department administration.
OverHead Desktop	Regular Windows 10/11 workstation.	Individual-user product; it is not a Cylinder workstation client.

Do not confuse the roles
Cylinder is a product access and device-policy layer. It does not configure native Windows Group Policy, Active Directory, Entra, a VPN, or firewall rules.

Cylinder Server, Cylinder Client, and Desktop have separate app identities, local data roots, and update feeds. The client is optional; not every organization needs to deploy it.

2. Plan the department deployment

1. Choose a supported Windows Server or Windows IoT host for Cylinder Server. Keep the host patched and protected by the organization's normal administrator controls.
2. Choose managed Windows 10/11 endpoints or remote desktop endpoints for Cylinder Client.
3. Decide who will be the verified workspace Owner and identify recovery access before inviting employees.
4. Plan department names, employee Ranks, job functions, and the devices each employee may use.
5. If remote users need access, configure the organization's approved VPN/network path and Windows administration controls separately. Cylinder does not provide or configure them.
6. Keep a separate backup plan for local workspace data, customer attachments, and generated documents.

The Manager performs Windows edition, architecture, memory, processor, storage, package-integrity, and signature-policy checks before installation/update. The supported package is x64; native ARM64 is not enabled. Server and Client compatibility requirements are different.

Do not share a Server installer with workstation users
Use the Cylinder Client package for endpoint workstations. The Server launcher should stop on a standard Windows workstation, and the Client launcher should stop on Server/IoT editions.

3. Install, sign in, and connect a workspace

1. Open the OverHead Install Manager and choose the intended product: Cylinder Server for the compatible department host, or the optional Cylinder Client target for a managed Windows 10/11 workstation.

2. Review the detected Windows edition, hardware, package-integrity, and publisher status. The Manager stops if the selected target is not compatible.
3. For a first installation, read the Manager notices and select the explicit Yes, I agree option to continue. Selecting No, I do not agree cancels installation.
4. When replacing an installed version, review the selected product and version. The Manager verifies a data backup, asks before removal, installs the matching package, and checks the installed version and data afterward.
5. Open Cylinder Server and create the intended workspace or sign in to an existing workspace. Confirm the Owner account is the authorized workspace owner.
6. Use the optional Cylinder Client on each supported workstation. A Server install can stage the client installer and deployment script if included in the package.
7. Sign in to Cylinder Client with a verified employee account invited to the same workspace. Follow the device enrollment and authorization state displayed by the app.
8. If the app reports Pending device or membership, ask an authorized Cylinder administrator to review it. Do not reuse another employee's credentials or device token.

First Owner installation is allowed to bootstrap management. Further Owner installations and employee devices can begin Pending until an authorized Rank approves them. Device credentials are kept in the encrypted local store and can be revoked through device management; they are not hardware attestation.

The Manager keeps Cylinder Server and Cylinder Client installation folders, release assets, and data paths separate. Uninstall keeps local data by default. Optional data removal requires its own choice and typed confirmation. The Manager displays a release date when an update is available; its window does not show a Manager version number.

> **Customer portal is separate**
> Cylinder Customer Access is not the employee sign-in path. Customer accounts do not become Cylinder employees and must not be used for staff administration.

4. Manage employees, departments, and Ranks

Rank	Name	Typical authority
4	Owner	Workspace-wide employee, department, device, version/offline/pause policy, and audit controls.
3	Administrator	Manage lower ranks and devices/audit within assigned departments.
2	Management	Manage Rank 1 employees in overlapping departments.
1	Regular User	Use Cylinder as allowed by membership, job function, department, and device policy.

A user's job function (such as Support, Front Desk, or Bookkeeper) is separate from their Cylinder Rank. Rank determines management authority; job function helps shape day-to-day work. No actor can assign or manage a rank equal to or higher than their own.

1. Open Cylinder Management from the Server workspace using an authorized account.
2. Invite employees using an existing active Firebase account or create a new invite as permitted by your Rank and department scope.
3. Assign only the department and job function needed for the employee's work.
4. Ask the employee to complete the email verification/account setup flow. A pending invite activates only after verified sign-in.

5. Review the employee's device enrollment. Approve, block, or retire devices only within your authorized scope.
6. Review the audit trail after consequential changes.

> **Department scope boundary**
> Department assignments limit Cylinder administration and device eligibility. They do not filter operational customer records or automatically synchronize files by department.

5. Set workspace and device policies

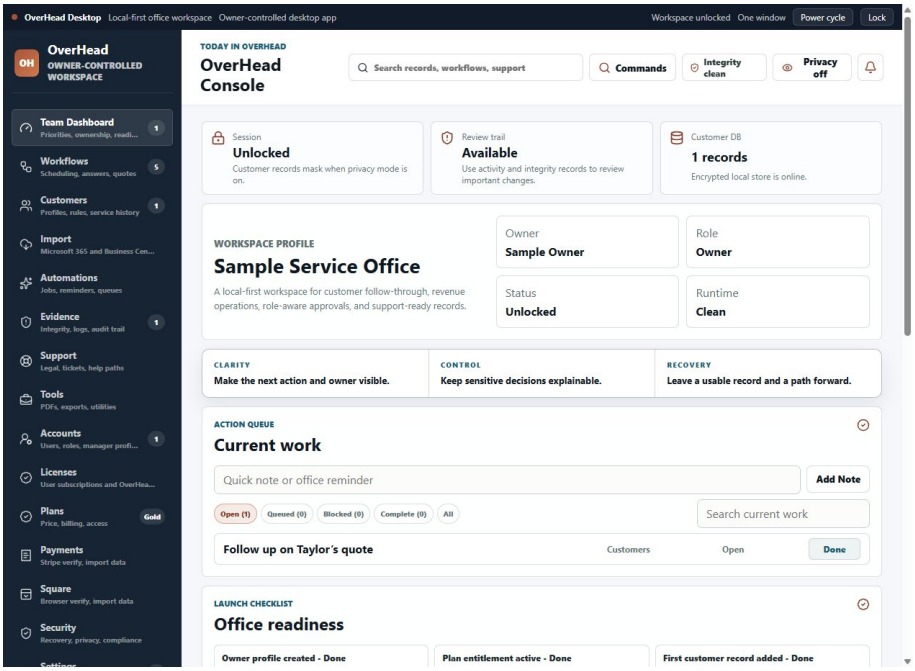
- Minimum app version: an Owner can require employee ranks to use at least a chosen version. The Owner's recovery access is exempt so the workspace can be recovered.
- Offline grace: the Owner sets an offline access window from 0 to 24 hours; the default is four hours. Use an interval that matches the department's operational requirements.
- Workspace pause: an Owner can pause employee Ranks 1-3 while retaining Owner recovery access.
- Device approval: Rank 3 and Rank 4 administrators can approve, block, or retire devices within permitted departments. They can constrain which employees use a device.
- Revocation timing: account and device changes require a successful online policy check. A previously authorized session can continue offline until its configured grace expires.

> **No general Windows policy engine**
> Cylinder's policies protect access to OverHead. They do not create or deploy Group Policy Objects, manage Active Directory, enforce device encryption, configure VPN, or replace endpoint-management software.

6. Use the shared office workflows

Cylinder uses the same core workspace patterns as Desktop: Team Dashboard, Customers, Workflows, appointments, quotes, invoices, documents, reports, scheduling, and supported integrations. Available actions depend on the user's Cylinder Rank, job function, membership, device authorization, and account access.

1. Use Team Dashboard to review current work and record a clear next action.
2. Add or select the intended customer before creating related appointments, quotes, or invoices.
3. Review saved status and amounts separately from real-world events such as sending, accepting, or paying an invoice.
4. Attach files to the intended customer. Keep original documents and a separate backup because attachments remain local.
5. Use reports, exports, and support bundles only after reviewing the destination and contents.



Shared workspace example. This illustrative image is not a Cylinder control-plane view.

The standard Desktop plan checkout does not sell Cylinder. Cylinder uses its separate evaluation and entitlement path. Confirm current plan and deployment terms with the authorized owner before relying on paid features.

7. Know where Cylinder data lives

Data	Where it is used/stored	What it does not mean
Cylinder employee identity, membership, Rank, device policy	Firebase-backed Cylinder control plane.	Not a shared file server or Windows directory service.
Local customer records, work, attachments, PDFs	On the Windows installation that created or stores the records.	Not automatically copied from Server to Client or across departments.
Encrypted user/device credentials and caches	Local encrypted application store.	Not hardware attestation and not a complete central employee directory.
Backups/exports	Local folders chosen by the user or Manager.	Not a substitute for a separate off-device backup.

The central service checks the user's active membership, device status, department overlap, workspace policy, and current app version when online. Local operational records and customer documents do not automatically follow the employee to another endpoint.

1. Create a verified local workspace backup from Settings before a risky operation or major change.
2. Keep attachments and generated files in a separate protected backup plan.
3. For restoration or migration, verify the intended host and data folder; a restore replaces local data rather than merging it.
4. After restore, verify sample customers, tasks, attachments, and synchronization state separately.

8. Update and maintain Server and Client separately

Cylinder Server and Cylinder Client use separate installers and Firebase update feeds. Their automatic updates use the standalone Electron updater, not the OverHead Desktop Install Manager workflow. Automatic checks are scheduled and bounded; the app can fall back to a matching stable GitHub release if the Firebase feed is unavailable.

Variant	Update feed
Cylinder Server	https://overhead-office.web.app/updates/cylinder/latest.yml
Cylinder Client	https://overhead-office.web.app/updates/cylinder-client/latest.yml

Keep the Server and Client on compatible release levels when the Owner sets a minimum version. Do not install the Desktop feed or installer on a Cylinder host. Review the release date, product name, version, and package trust status before updating.

> **Update and consent**
> Cylinder's standalone updater retains its product-specific update workflow. The separate Manager can install or remove supported products, but its product list and trust policy must match the package being managed.

9. Back up, troubleshoot, and recover

Issue	What to check
Employee cannot sign in	Confirm verified Firebase account, active Cylinder membership, correct workspace, and invitation status.
Device is Pending or Blocked	Ask an authorized Rank 3/4 administrator to review device enrollment and department scope.
Employee denied while offline	Check connectivity and configured offline grace; do not bypass policy by sharing credentials.
Minimum version blocks access	Update the correct Server/Client package from its matching feed.
Client/server edition mismatch	Use Cylinder Server on compatible Server/IoT or Cylinder Client on a supported Windows 10/11 endpoint.
Missing customer record	Confirm correct local installation and workspace; shared control-plane membership does not replicate local operational data.
Update failed	Check network and product-specific feed; preserve data and logs before retrying.

Owners should protect the verified Owner account and enroll a second trusted Owner installation for recovery. There is no Rank 4 transfer or owner-recovery workflow described by the current product. If the only Owner identity becomes unavailable, use the documented support channel before attempting data or membership changes.

For support, include product variant, version, Windows edition/build, workspace role, device status, exact error, and the last successful step. Do not send passwords, device credentials, recovery links, or unredacted customer information.